
HS 471: Contemporary India

Course Code	HS 471
Course Name	Contemporary India
L-T-P-C	3-0-0-3
Prerequisites	no
Intended for	3rd and 4th Year B.Tech/PhD
Distribution	Elective for HSS
Approval	10th Senate (Jun 2016)
Discontinued	23rd Senate (Oct 2019)

Course Contents

- **Critical Events**

- The Year 1991: A decisive move towards economic liberalization
- Coalition politics and assertive presence of Regional Political Parties
- The Mandal Commission Report: Aftermath
- Debates on Indian secularism in the 1980s
- Hindutva movement, ethnic violence and minority politics f. Expansion and Deepening role of Visual Media [6 Lectures]

- **State, Governance and Political Structure**

- Economic Liberalization and Economic Growth (India and state level), Institutional Changes for Policy Delivery, and Emerging Nature of State in the New Economy
- Nature of Party System, Federalism, new forms of political mobilization
- Political Decentralization and deepening democracy
- Newer forms of decentralization and variety of local formal institutions [8 Lectures]

- **Religion and Culture**

- secularism and secularization
- (re)casting and (re)construction of social history
- religious effervescence and identity: minority and majority debate d. religious and ethnic violence
- religious market [8 Lectures]

- **Transnationalism and New Spaces for Socio-Economic Articulation**

- transnationalism and cosmopolitanism
- spaces for consumption and spaces of consumption
- virtual spaces and digital technology
- spaces at margins
- new spaces inclusion and marginalization [10 Lectures]

- **Socio-Political Groups and Ideologies: Old and New**

- Trade Unions, New Forms of Trade Unionism and Business Interest Groups
- Old and New Social Movements
- NRIs, Indian Middle Class and New Middle Class
- Youth in Contemporary India: Demographic Dividends, Aspirations and Aspects of mobilities [10 Lectures]

References

1. Das, Veena., 1995, Critical Events: an anthropological perspective on contemporary India, OUP.
2. Inda, Jonathan Xavier and Renato Rosaldo., 2002, The anthropology of globalization: a reader, Blackwell.
3. Sen, Amartya., 1983, Development: which way now? The Economic Journal. Vol. 93. pp 745-62.
4. Rajagopal, Arvind., 2002, Politics after television: Hindu nationalism and reshaping of the public in India, Cambridge University Press.
5. Reddy, Ram Manohar., How is India Doing, Guhan Memorial Lecture.
6. Dreze, Jean and Amartya Sen., 1995, India: economic development and social opportunity, Oxford University Press.
7. Harriss-White, Barbara., 2003, India working: essays on society and economy, Cambridge University Press.
8. Corbridge, Stuart and John Harriss., 2000, Reinventing India: liberalization, Hindu nationalism and popular democracy, Polity Press.
9. Bhargava, Rajiv (ed.), 1998, Secularism and its critique, OUP.
10. Bhargava, Rajiv., 2013, Reimagining Secularism: respect, domination and principled distance, Economic and Political Weekly. Pp 79-92.
11. Venu, M.K., The India of 2013 is not the India of 1991, The Hindu, August 29, 2013.
12. Ahluwalia, Montek Singh., Economic Reforms in India since 1991: Has Gradualism Worked?
13. Nagaraj, R., 1997, What has happened since 1991? assessment of India's economic reforms. Economic and Political Weekly. 2869-79.
14. Jaffrelot, Christophe., 2000, The rise of the other backward classes in the Hindi belt, The Journal of Asian Studies, Vol. 59(1):86-108.
15. Ram, Nandu (ed.), 2008, Dalits in contemporary India: discrimination and discontent, Siddhant Publications. pp 37-64.
16. Robinson, Rowena, 2012, Minority Studies, Oxford University Press. Pp 1-48.
17. Donner, Henerik., 2011, Being middle-class in India: a way of life, Routledge.
18. Fernandes, Leela., The Politics of Forgetting: class politics, state power and the restructuring of urban space., Urban Studies, Vol. 41, 12, pp 2415-30.
19. Kohli, Atul., 2012, Poverty amid Plenty in the New India: Politics, Economics and Inequality, Cambridge University Press.
20. Kohli, Atul., 2009, Democracy and Development in India: From Socialism to Pro-Business, Oxford University Press.
21. Shatkin, Gavin and Sanjeev Vidhyarthi, 2013, Contesting the Indian city: global visions and politics of the local, Pp 1-38. Oxford: Wiley Blackwell.
22. Guha-Banerjee, Swapna., 2010, Accumulation by dispossession: transformative cities in the new global order, Sage.
23. Mathur, Nita., 2013, Consumer culture, modernity and identity, Sage.
24. Kakar, Sudhir., 1996, Colours of violence: cultural identities, religion and violence, OUP.